

CALVIN TOLBERT

School of Operations Research and Information Engineering · Cornell University
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EDUCATION

Cornell University

Ithaca, NY

Ph.D., Operations Research and Information Engineering

May 2028 (expected)

- Advisor: David Bindel
- Research interests: Bayesian optimization, sampling algorithms, numerical methods in operations research

Stanford University

Stanford, CA

M.S., Management Science and Engineering

June 2023

B.A.S., Classics, Mathematics (Minor in Economics)

June 2021

ASSISTANTSHIPS

Graduate Research Assistant to Professor Peter Frazier

May 2026-Present

- Worked on a project through the Office of Naval Research to develop an AI harness for making military logistical decisions and formulating optimization problems.
- Was responsible for reviewing existing literature on AI for optimization and emphasizing originality of the harness.
- Currently working on integrating preference learning into the tool.

Course Assistant to Professors Jack Muckstadt and Eric Gentsch

May 2025-August 2025

- Integrated course materials from ORIE's flagship supply chain management course into a self-contained instructor's packet.
- Split the lectures and assignments into units by topic and by mathematical content to make the course customizable to environments where different levels of mathematical preparation are assumed.
- Helped modernize the spreadsheets from the assignments and the graphics in the lecture slides.

Graduate Research Assistant to Professor Christina Lee Yu

January 2024-August 2024

- Worked on matrix completion using tools from linear algebra, electrical engineering, and mathematical statistics.
- Presented our lab's work on using network flow to model potential outcomes in a fixed effects model.
- Wrote Python code to implement different matrix completion algorithms.

PUBLICATIONS

Works in Progress

"Low-rank Bayesian matrix completion" 2026

Calvin Tolbert

"Trend-informed Bayesian optimization" 2026

Darian Nwankwo, Calvin Tolbert, David Bindel

"Global optimization of acquisition functions" 2026

Calvin Tolbert, Michael Czekanski, David Bindel

PRESENTATIONS & TALKS

Departmental & Group Presentations

“Low-rank Bayesian matrix completion”

Bindel Lab, Ithaca, NY

September 11, 2026

ORIE Ph.D. Colloquium, Ithaca, NY

March 26, 2026

Conference & Workshop Presentations

“Trend-informed Bayesian optimization”

Young Researchers Workshop, Ithaca, NY (poster)

October 9, 2025

NYC Ops Day, New York, NY

March 27, 2025

“Minimax optimal estimates of individual causal effects in panel data under heterogeneous two-way fixed effects models”

American Causal Inference Conference, Seattle, WA (poster)

May 15, 2024

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

Guest Lecturer

ORIE 5110: Engineering Economics and Strategic Decision-Making

September 9, 2026

“Project Analysis: Loans and Interest, NPV/Payback/IRR”

ORIE 4126/5126: Principles of Supply Chain Management

February 24, 2026

“Mathematical Analysis of Supply Chain Behavior: The Inevitable ‘Bullwhip Effect’”

Teaching Assistant

Cornell University courses, by semester:

MATH 2940: Linear Algebra for Engineers

Fall 2026

ORIE 5110: Engineering Economics and Strategic Decision-Making

Fall 2026

ORIE 4126/5126: Principles of Supply Chain Management

Spring 2026

MATH 1920: Multivariable Calculus for Engineers

Fall 2025

ORIE 3741/5741: Learning with Big Messy Data

Spring 2025

ORIE 4350/5350: Introduction to Game Theory

Fall 2024

Stanford University courses, by quarter:

MS&E 230: Market Design for Engineers

Spring 2023

MS&E 241: Economic Analysis

Winter 2023

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Programming & Tools: Python, Julia, GitHub

Methods: Optimization, numerical methods, Markov chain Monte Carlo, causal inference

SERVICE & PROFESSIONAL ACTIVITIES

- Organizer, Ph.D. Visit Days, Cornell ORIE, 2026-present

REFERENCES (THESIS COMMITTEE)

Professor David Bindel (bindel@cs.cornell.edu)

Department of Computer Science, Cornell University

Professor Peter Frazier (pf98@cornell.edu)

School of Operations Research and Information Engineering, Cornell University

Professor Jamol Pender (jjp274@cornell.edu)

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